

The Art of Illusion

● Green Level: I Want More Support

Name: _____ Date: _____ Period: _____



What is Suspension of Disbelief?

When you watch a play or movie, you KNOW it's not real. The actors aren't really the characters, and the set isn't a real place. But you **choose to pretend** it's real so you can enjoy the story!

Big Idea: Theatre illusion is like a game—the audience agrees to "believe" even though they know it's fake. This is different from being tricked without your permission!



Theatrical Tricks

Match each theatrical technique to what it creates:

Colored lights	Make actors appear and disappear
Trap doors	Create mood (scary, happy, romantic)
Sound effects	Make a simple set look real
Painted backdrops	Thunder, rain, footsteps



What Do You "Believe"?

Think about the last play, movie, or show you watched. What did you "pretend" was real?

I pretended that...

The Art of Illusion

● Green Level

Theatre vs. Tricks

What's the difference between theatre illusions and being tricked?

Theatre: You KNOW it's fake, and you CHOOSE to enjoy it.

Being Tricked: You DON'T know it's fake, and someone is fooling you.

Circle the right answer:

A magician at a show makes a rabbit "appear." This is: **Theatre** / **Being Tricked**

Someone edits a photo to make you believe something false. This is: **Theatre** / **Being Tricked**

An actor pretends to cry in a play. This is: **Theatre** / **Being Tricked**

Mini Museum Connection

The Victorians used the SAME techniques for theatre AND for fake "ghost photos." The difference? Theatre audiences knew it was fake. People who bought spirit photographs didn't!

Visit: minimuseumproject.com/exhibitions/seeing-is-deceiving

Share with Your Family!

Watch a movie or show with your family. Talk about what theatrical tricks help you "believe" the story!